

Ten Reasons Why We Should Use Linux

There are many reasons why Linux is preferred over proprietary software. This article lists the top ten.

Until a few years ago, Linux was used mainly for servers and was not considered suitable for desktops. But its user interface and ease of use has been steadily improving over the last few years. Linux has today become user-friendly enough to replace Windows on desktops. It is being used by hundreds of thousands of people across the globe. Here are the ten most important reasons why Linux ought to be adopted by home users, educational institutes and businesses.

around once a year or so to keep it in good condition. Once installed, the Linux OS need not be reinstalled for years. The Linux OS runs exactly as fast as it did when first installed, even after several years. Most of us must have experienced how a freshly installed Windows system runs extremely fast and the same system becomes slow after around six months to one year. The same system becomes very slow and, gradually, begins to run like a snail within six months to one year. Then, your only option most of the time is to reinstall the OS and all the other software.

The uptime for the Linux servers is very high and the availability is around 99.9 per cent. Unlike Windows, you need not reboot a Linux server after every update or patch. Due to this, Linux has the highest number of servers running on the Internet.

According to an article on the *znet* website, 96.3 per cent of the top 1 million Web servers are running on Linux. Twenty-three out of the Top twenty five websites run on Linux. The two remaining websites in the top twenty five are *live.com* and *bing.com*, which belong to Microsoft!

3. Ease of maintenance:

Maintaining the Linux OS is easy, as the user can centrally update the OS and all software installed very easily. All the variants of Linux have their own central software repository, which is used to update the system and keep it safe. They offer regular updates and the system can be updated without rebooting it. The updating can be done periodically, with just a few clicks, or users can even automate the updating process. Updating a Windows system is not so easy compared to a Linux system. Also, in Windows, all the third party software like Acrobat Reader, Firefox, etc, have to be updated individually.

4. Runs on any hardware: All of us know that with every new release of Windows OS, a huge number of hardware systems become obsolete as their technical specifications are no longer adequate to run the latest Windows OS. Linux makes very efficient use of the system's resources. Linux installation can be customised for users and for specific hardware requirements. The installation procedure is very flexible, and allows users to choose the modules they want to install. This allows them to install Linux even on old hardware, thus helping in optimal use of all the hardware resources.

1. High security: Installing and using Linux on your system is the easiest way to avoid viruses and malware. The security aspect was kept in mind when developing Linux and it is much less vulnerable to viruses compared to Windows. Programs cannot make changes to the system settings and configuration unless the user is logged in as the root (equivalent to the administrator user in Windows) user. Most users do not log in as the root; hence, they cannot do much damage to the system, except to their own files and programs, since the downloaded file/malware will have limited privileges. You can browse the Internet without worrying about your system getting infected. However, users can install *ClamAV* antivirus software in Linux to further secure their systems.

The reason for this higher level of security is that since Linux is open source software, the source code is available for review. A huge number of developers all over the world have gone through the code, which means that most of the flaws have already been discovered.

2. High stability: The Linux system is very stable and is not prone to crashes. The latter usually has to be reinstalled

